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Int GCSE Geography 4GE1 02

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Introduction

Introduction

This paper consists of three sections. Candidates answer two 25-mark questions from section A, one 20-mark question from section B, and one 35-mark question from section C. The fieldwork questions in section B include questions on both familiar and unfamiliar fieldwork contexts.

The total number of marks for the paper is 105. The exam includes multiple-choice questions, short, open response calculations and extended response questions. The examination command words which are used in the paper are defined in the specification. Each of the questions is mapped to one or more of the Assessment Objectives (AOs).

In **Section A** candidates choose two questions from Economic Activity and Energy, Rural Environments and Urban Environments. The final part is an 8-mark extended response question that targets AO3 and AO4.

In **Section B** candidates choose one out of three fieldwork related questions concerning Economic Activity and Energy, Rural Environments or Urban Environments. In this paper there were short response questions based on an unfamiliar fieldwork context followed by an 8-mark extended response question based on a familiar fieldwork context.

In **Section C** candidates choose one out of three questions covering Fragile Environments and Climate Change, Globalisation and Migration or Development and Human Welfare. This section includes a range of question types finishing with a 12-mark extended response question which targets AO2, AO3 and AO4.

An important part of the extended response question is the particular command word that is used. The use of 'analyse', 'evaluate' or 'discuss' requires candidates to consider how to address these in their response, moving beyond basic explanations and demonstration of knowledge. While many candidates are attempting to address these command words, many still need to ensure that they have made relevant points to demonstrate they have addressed these command words. These extended response questions also require clear use of the resources (the questions remind candidates to refer to the resources). In general, candidates did attempt to include use of the resources provided.

Please note that there are no comments or exemplars for questions 4 and 5. There are comments and exemplars for question 6 as this is the most popular question chosen as an option and all advice and guidance applies to questions 4 and 5 too. The questions are provided in parallel and the resources for each are similar but with a different fieldwork context.

Question 1(a)ii

Most candidates were able to identify one factor that can affect the location of tertiary sector industries. The most common factor was the availability of customers or transport to get to the site.

(ii) State **one** factor that affects the location of tertiary sector industries.

(1)

Customers. Tertiary Sector needs active people to service. Jobs such as a Taxi, Hairdresser all need customers.



This response provides a relevant factor – customers/people to service are all needed by taxis and hairdressers (1 mark).



The command word 'state' does not require a lengthy response; one or two words or a short phrase is sufficient. However, students must ensure that the answer is specific enough and relevant to obtain the mark.

Question 1(c)

In this type of question it's very important to use information directly from the resource. Most candidates were able to provide a clear reason for the change in primary employment. The most popular reasons were raw materials running out, mechanisation or development causing technology in farming, reducing worker numbers.

(c) Study Figure 1a in the Resource Booklet.

Suggest **one** reason for the change in primary sector employment.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

The amount of raw materials may be running out meaning that the number of people required to work in the primary sector is decreasing

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Examiner Comments

In this response the candidate starts by providing a reason for the change and identifying the change in the primary and secondary sector. It has implied use of the source as the graph (Figure 1a) shows the number of people in the primary industry are decreasing (2 marks).

Question 1(d)

The majority of candidates were able to name a non-renewable energy source, with coal being the most popular choice. However, a small number of candidates confused renewable with non-renewable resources. Some candidates missed the mark by stating the too broad option of 'fossil fuels' which does not meet the question requirement of 'one example'.

(d) State **one** example of a non-renewable energy source.

(1)

Coal.

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Examiner Comments

A relevant non-renewable energy source is identified. (1 mark)

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Candidates are encouraged to learn the definition and examples of key words throughout the specification.

Question 1(e)

Many candidates were able to provide two ways transport can be made more sustainable. Most candidates identified appropriate methods such as use of electric vehicles and public transport or cycling. The highest scoring answers were able to explain how these methods improved energy efficiency or reduced fossil fuel use, as well as improving people's health. A large number of candidates used the same reason twice (ie referring to reduced greenhouse gases). This limited their score to 3 marks as development reasons must not be identical in this style of question.

(e) Explain **two** ways transport can be made more sustainable.

(4)

1 Better public transport such as buses can reduce the number of cars on the road, reducing air pollution and slowing ~~global warm~~ climate change.

2 More electric bike schemes in cities as it reduces air pollution but also increases people's daily physical excercise, implimenting positive and progressive schemes that will help those in the future as well as the present.

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Examiner Comments

This response has provided two developed responses around improving public transport systems to reduce car use and therefore positively impacting climate change-related air pollution and the use of (electric) bike schemes improving the individual's physical health. (2+2=4 marks). By going beyond air pollution this candidate was able to more easily achieve all the marks.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

On this style of question try to use entirely different reasons/explanations for the ways selected – sometimes when considering sustainability looking at this from a social, economic or environmental viewpoint can make this easier.

Question 1(f)

The 3-mark 'suggest' questions can be challenging, as they require candidates to demonstrate double development of their ideas. In this question, candidates needed to identify an impact of the wind farm in close proximity to the village shown in figure 1b. The most common responses focused on the need to further damage the environment in the form of deforestation to increase the size of (extend) the wind farm. In the strongest answers, further marks were awarded for clearly explaining how this contributes to loss of habitat/biodiversity. Some candidates legitimately took the view of the villagers who would experience noise or visual pollution and therefore wish to move away/have a reduction in their house value. A few - more optimistic - candidates thought that the village would benefit from the increase in local electricity and further reducing their carbon footprint which was plausible and therefore credited.

Not all students recognised that the question referred to the **landscape** and instead gave impacts for the economy of Germany as a whole for no credit.

(f) Study Figure 1b in the Resource Booklet.

Suggest **one** potential impact of expanding wind energy production on the landscape shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(3)

Figure 1b shows a wind turbine farm in a rural area. The large machines may disrupt surrounding ecosystems. Certain habitats may have been destroyed during contruction, could contribute to extinction.

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Examiner Comments

This response uses photographic evidence of wind turbines in a rural area (1) causing disruption/extinction of ecosystems/habitats (1) during construction (1). (3 marks).

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Candidates should be reminded that unqualified pollution by itself is not creditworthy. Named types of pollution such as noise and visual pollution are creditable.

Question 1(g)

Many candidates were able to provide suitable factors that can affect energy demand in a developing or emerging country. There is space to indicate their chosen country. Quite a few candidates were not able to select the right development context for their answer (giving examples such as the UK or Germany). Prevalent answers focus on population growth increasing demand and mechanisation/development increasing technology use in factories to produce goods.

A small number of candidates confused 'supply' and 'demand'.

(g) For a named developing or emerging country, explain **two** factors that can affect energy demand.

(4)

Developing or emerging country

China

1 In China, energy demand may be increased due to the big secondry sector of employment. Alot of energy is needed for the factories which produce goods

2 In china, the population effects the energy demand. When the population rises due to potential factors like natural increase and better healthcare services, the demand for energy rises.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response has provided a developed reason for the first part around the population of China increasing energy demand for secondary industry as factories producing goods need a lot of power. The second part gives a creditable reason of a rising population having more needs such as healthcare demands (2+2=4 marks).

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

As long as the factor and its explanation are plausible for the type of country required then credit should be given. Arguably China's population growth is stagnating but in the context of a developing/emerging country this is a correct response, so has been allowed as appropriate.

Question 1(h)

These 8-mark style questions require the blending of the use of resources provided with the candidates' own knowledge and understanding. They are not case study questions but are more applied. The same skill, with the same Assessment Objectives (AO3 and AO4), is tested in the other options for questions 2 and 3. The mark scheme also has three levels which are fixed year on year.

There is an instruction on the question paper that 'You **must** use the resource in your answer'. Most candidates clearly used the resource to consider the different relationships shown between population growth and resources. To reach the higher-level candidates need to do more than describe what is presented in the resource. Clear developed relationships must be shown. The command word 'analyse' needs to be addressed to achieve full marks. Many candidates found this last part challenging as they did not know how to demonstrate analysis. It was encouraging to note that some candidates successfully addressed this, frequently through temporal analysis or by linking their response to contemporary agrarian development.

Comments relating to Ester Boserup were consistently better than those relating to Thomas Malthus. Most discussion centred around increasing food production through the Green Revolution, GM crops, aquaculture or irrigation.

The best answers explained who they thought was right and why, and a select few suggested that either/both had already been proven right (referring to famine/war or the Green Revolution as evidence) or contextualised it to parts of the world that had experience, suggested by either or both models.

Question 2(a)ii

Most candidates were able to state a characteristic of a tundra biome. The most popular response related to temperature, ie very cold. More adventurous responses included strong winds, dry/arid and stunted vegetation, which were all awarded one mark.

The most common wrong responses were 'wet' and 'has pine trees' which scored 0 marks.

(ii) State **one** characteristic of a tundra biome.

(1)

strong winds

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

A correct characteristic (1 mark)

Question 2(c)

With these types of questions, where there is an AO3 mark coming from the resource, it is key to use direct evidence, in this case a picture of a terraced, flooded field for growing crops with a settlement to the left of the image. Most candidates identified this farming landscape either using appropriate terminology or accurate description.

A small number of candidates attempted to identify tourist activities within the image, but these were not considered valid.

(c) Study Figure 2a in the Resource Booklet.

Suggest **one** piece of evidence humans have changed this environment.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

~~The~~ The stairlike gradient of the hills. This is not natural, humans have created these different levels so that crops can grow better on the hills.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response uses evidence from the photograph and describes how this relates to farming showing a change from the natural landscape. (2 marks)

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

When a question includes a resource, candidates should clearly describe how the evidence from the resource supports or illustrates the point required by the question. They must go beyond simply stating what the resource shows and explain its relevance to the question being asked.

Question 2(d)

This question requires candidates to state one strategy used to improve air quality in rural environments. Most candidates tended to state strategies relating to planting trees or reducing vehicle emissions.

(d) State **one** strategy used to improve air quality in rural environments.

(1)

Using electric ~~[illegible]~~ cars to not pollute the atmosphere with car pollution.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response provides a relevant idea for 1 mark. While electric cars are not completely pollution-free the question asks for improvement to air quality in rural environments, so this idea is valid.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

These responses require one basic idea for a single mark - there is no point writing longer answers as there is only one mark available.

Question 2(e)

In general, there were lots of good answers of the advantages and disadvantages of GM crops. Popular advantages included reduced use of chemicals such as pesticides or drought-resistance, alongside disadvantages like cost as a barrier to use because of their need for scientific research and people being wary of them owing to a lack of data relating to long term effects on human health – this was accepted as a plausible reason owing to lack of evidence to the contrary.

(e) Explain **one** advantage and **one** disadvantage of using genetically modified (GM) crops.

(4)

advantage

One advantage, is that GM crops can be modified to produce a higher yield. This higher yield can then be sold for a greater profit for the farmer, as more crops have been produced.

disadvantage

One disadvantage, is that GM crops are usually expensive, so they are only accessible to certain farmers. They are expensive, due to the scientific research that went into them.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

In this response there is a developed advantage and disadvantage. (2+2=4 marks) Modified for a higher yield (1) sold for a greater profit for the farmer (1) Usually expensive to create owing to scientific research required (1) so only available to certain farmers (1).

Question 2(f)

In this question, candidates were required to use information from the resource to suggest how governments can help reduce isolation in rural environments. Many candidates correctly identified the role of governments in providing funding for public transport or services. However, only a minority were able to develop their chosen examples to explain how these interventions could help address isolation in rural areas.

These 3 mark questions can be difficult, so candidates need to practise how to model a response that develops a single idea or reason and makes reference to information from the resource.

Question 2(g)

Most candidates were able to provide some relevant explanations of ways that the farm economies are changing. The question requires a developing country context. While most did select a suitable country, there were some that did not provide a country context or provided a developed country.

The majority of candidates were able to identify a country they had clearly studied and explain how farm economies have evolved over time, with some strong responses relating to the development and opportunities of tourism growth and diversification. There were some more unusual and well-thought out responses relating to particular locations which is always pleasing to see.

(g) Explain **two** ways farm economies are changing in a named developing or emerging country.

(4)

Named developing or emerging country

Kenya

1 Farm economies are reducing due to a lack of labour due to rural-urban migration. The farmland becomes less productive as there are less people working the land. Less yield.

2 Land is becoming deserted due to drought and overgrazing, so there is less fertile land. To overcome this, the government supply irrigation ~~plant~~ shemes to reduce drought, so land can be productive. ~~They are~~



This response is a 2+2 answer with developed ideas around farm productivity and increasing issues associated with water supply.

Question 2(h)

This question requires candidates to analyse possible changes to rural areas. The resource showed a graph of % employment in agriculture in European countries in 2005 and 2020. It was encouraging to see that many candidates made good use of the resource. Even at the lower end of marks, which focused on description of the data rather than explanation, there was clear engagement with the resource to form the response.

A notable number of candidates wrote about the causes of out-migration rather than the effects of the changes to rural areas so scored limited development marks.

(h) Study Figure 2c in the Resource Booklet.

Analyse the possible changes to rural areas caused by the trend shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(8)

Figure 2c shows ~~that~~ that all of the countries' percentage of agriculture has decreased ~~in~~ during 2005 to 2020. For example, in ~~Cro~~ Croatia which had significant decrease, people left to find better jobs in urban areas, which is rural to urban migration.
Figure 2c shows that Romania had significant decrease in agriculture percentage. This could be because of mechanisation, causing rural-urban migration, and rural areas are experiencing ageing population. This leads to less productive agricultural work with less young people, causing more people to leave rural areas, which is a negative multiplier effect.
Figure 2c shows that Germany experienced a decrease in agricultural work. This is because it is cheaper to import foods abroad for a developed county than to produce it in the county, which is caused by globalisation. However as it is developed, there might be counter-urbanisation happening, decreasing the rural isolation in the rural areas, increasing the quality of life.



This response contains developed ideas with reference to the resource looking at three nations. It has a good range of ideas and shows a good understanding of changes. Its major weakness is in AO4 though – it uses none of the data from the source except to suggest a decrease for all locations. To access Level 3 marks the candidate must use data to back up their argument. Both axes of the graph need to be referenced in an advanced answer to show candidates have read the graph and to allow them to access the top level.



When given a graph as a resource make sure you have used all parts of it in your answer to achieve a top level - if it has axes use information from both axes, not just one.

Question 3(a)ii

Most candidates were able to state a factor that has led to the growth of megacities. There were many responses relating to rural to urban migration, increasing in population and job opportunities. Some more able candidates used economies of scale, multiplier effect and agglomeration. For a straightforward one-mark question like this all relevant ideas were credited.

(ii) State **one** factor that has led to the growth of megacities.

(1)

Multiplyer effect

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Examiner Comments

This response identifies a valid factor: multiplier effect. Spelling does not matter as long as the answer is able to be understood so it is not an issue that it is misspelt. (1 mark)

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

The command word 'state' does not require a lengthy response; one or two words or a short phrase is sufficient. However, candidates must ensure that the answer is specific enough and relevant to obtain the mark.

Question 3(c)

As mentioned previously, in this type of question it is essential that candidates use information directly from the resource. Examiners are looking for explicit references to Figure 3a and relevant evidence drawn from the image. The majority of candidates were able to identify the waste dumped in the river shown in Figure 3a, although a significant number used an unqualified 'pollution' for no credit, there were many excellent ideas as to how politicians could manage this issue, such as provision of waste disposal infrastructure or clean-up campaigns.

(c) Study Figure 3a in the Resource Booklet.

Suggest **one** way politicians could manage an environmental challenge in this urban area.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

One way politicians can manage the environment is implementing fines and reinforcing punishments if garbage is thrown in the river, as shown in figure 3a, a polluted and trashed River in a urban area. This incentivises people not to do it.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This gets 2 marks as it identifies the environmental challenge as garbage thrown in the river and the way for a politician to manage it is to implement fines. Reinforcing punishments would also have scored. It does not matter which way round the answer is written so it is fine that the politician's action is written first.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

The word pollution must be qualified to score, in this case water pollution.

Question 3(d)

The majority of candidates provide a suitable reason for why segregation in cities can be a challenge. Many answers referred to inequality of opportunity or discrimination of one group of people.

Some candidates did not read the full question and misinterpreted the questions wrongly thinking that segregation was something that a government would be trying to achieve in a location.

(d) State **one** reason why segregation of groups of people in cities can be a challenge.

(1)

It can cause more employment / economic opportunities for one group resulting in inequality.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response scores 1 mark.

Question 3(e)

Overall, this question has many well-developed responses demonstrating clear knowledge and understanding of the reasons for counter-urbanisation. Common responses focused on high property prices in city centres, larger homes wanted for growing families, retirement causing older people to leave the city for a quieter life.

Less able candidates used some half arguments not concluding their idea with why they left the urban area as a result, therefore not scoring all the marks. A few candidates repeated their reason, and this resulted in them scoring 3 marks in total.

A minority of candidates were confused by the terminology counter-urbanisation and wrote about rural-urban migration instead.

Question 3(f)

This question required candidates to suggest a reason why informal settlements (squatter settlements) have created challenges in urban areas. The majority of candidates demonstrated a sound understanding of issues that people in informal settlements have.

Higher-scoring responses were able to explain consequences such as reduced hygiene standards and poor health as a result of living in cramped, high-density areas, and importantly, made clear links between these problems and the map showing squatter settlement growth rates in South America in Figure 3b.

(f) Study Figure 3b in the Resource Booklet.

Suggest **one** way the growth of informal settlements (squatter settlements) may create challenges in urban areas.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(3)

according to figure 3b, in central ad south america, informal settlements cortine to grow. for example, the figure shows that in argentina informal settlements grow 200-800% per year. this growth of informal settlements may lead to poor health ~~and~~ as disease spreads far easier in informal settlements, due to close proximity to others and poor hygine and sanitation.

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Examiner Comments

This response scores 1 mark for the use of data from Figure 3b of Argentina having an informal settlement growth rate of 201-600%. This scores a further two marks for the idea that health issues are caused by poor hygiene because of close proximity to others. 3 marks total.

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Examiner Tip

As a suggestion to make sure all three marks are awarded make sure you use one piece of evidence from the source, then use 'because' and 'so' to create a point with both explanation and development. This is not the only way to score full marks but it is a good way of making both development marks available.

Question 3(g)

In this question, candidates were required to explain reasons for development of the rural-urban fringe. Many responses were not as well explained as the counter-urbanisation question with the most common answer being for cheaper housing/land. Some good responses were apparent including information about science and business parks and the need for space and a much greener and quieter environment for quaternary industry to take place/attract graduates. A lot of candidates struggled for the second reason repeating their initial justification.

Question 3(h)

This question required candidates to analyse why the strategies shown could improve the quality of life in cities in developing or emerging countries. The resource focused on two strategies: one from Bangladesh and one from Africa (DARES). Many candidates were able to describe these strategies and suggest how they could benefit the locations in question. However, fewer candidates were able to effectively integrate evidence from the resource with wider discussion of other viable strategies or provide deeper analysis of their impacts.

A minority of students made direct reference to quality of life, and many used the more general idea of 'improvement'. There were many references to climate change and environmental change, without explaining the links between these and quality of life. However, when this was done, it was done very well. Gender equality was largely neglected. Reference to Dhaka was considerably better than reference to Dar es Salaam. Some excellent answers went well beyond the source to explain why reducing congestion might improve quality of life and/or thought 'outside the box'.

At the lower levels too many students simply lifted text from the resource which read quite well but was not able to score beyond level 1.

A significant number of candidates referred to Africa as a country, not a continent.

(h) Study Figure 3c in the Resource Booklet.

Analyse why the strategies shown could improve the quality of life in cities in developing or emerging countries.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(8)

Transportation is a big struggle in life. In 3c, it shows that Dhaka is the most congested cities in the world. This shows that the city is developing and there is an increasing population, so more demand for transport. However, they are developing several rail lines in the city to make going around faster.

Electricity supply is another very important struggle in life, that is essential. In Africa, 600 million people do not have access to electricity connections. This is quite bad, due to the fact that it is important for healthcare & and improvements in healthcare. However, investors are improving these areas.

The public in both countries/cities have a positive viewpoint on these problems. They are happy that the government (a top-down development) is doing something

to help. However, the snowball effect shows that when the population keeps on increasing, there will be more demand for transportation and electricity.

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Examiner Comments

This answer was scored as a level 1, 3 marks answer. Much of what is written here is copied straight from the source and it does not mention quality of life at all. While there are a couple of ideas such as 'snowball effect' which could potentially have been made into a relevant developed point, it is not made into anything beyond more description of the challenges, not looking at any quality of life improvements.

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Examiner Tip

Candidates should be given regular opportunities to practise using resources to analyse the importance of factors or ideas, demonstrating their ability to make meaningful connections between them in order to produce evidence-informed analysis. To fully meet the requirements of the 'analyse' command word, responses should include a range of well-developed points supported by clear judgement and reasoning.

Question 4(a)

Please see question 6 for comments relating to fieldwork (for all parts of the question).

Question 4(b)

Question 4(c)

Question 4(d)i

Question 4(d)ii

Question 4(d)iii

Question 4(e)

Question 4(f)

Question 5(a)

Please see question 6 for comments relating to fieldwork (for all parts of the question).

Question 5(b)

Question 5(c)

Question 5(d)i

Question 5(d)ii

Question 5(d)iii

Question 5(e)

Question 5(f)

Question 6(a)

Please note that the comments that follow for question 6 (Urban Environments) also apply to question 4 (Economic Activity and Energy) and question 5 (Rural Environments). Question 6 was the most popular option from section B so it makes sense to provide exemplars and commentary for this question. The questions are provided in parallel and the resources for each are similar but with a different fieldwork context.

In this paper there was a series of short response questions based on the unfamiliar fieldwork context, and an extended response question on a familiar fieldwork context. Candidates are provided with a space at the beginning of the familiar fieldwork context section to write the title of their enquiry. There were many candidates who provided very vague titles, no title at all or an irrelevant title.

The responses in this section show where candidates have clearly understood different aspects of their own fieldwork. It is important that candidates are able to consider different aspects of the fieldwork enquiry process and are prepared to answer questions on any of these from the design stages through to evaluation.

Question 6a - Most candidates could identify a piece of equipment relevant to the enquiry. The most common incorrect answer was 'photographs' on its own.

6 Investigating urban environments

Study Figures 6a and 6b in the Resource Booklet. They show some information about data collection methods students used and an extract from their questionnaire results.

> The aim of the students' enquiry was to investigate changes taking place to retailing in the central shopping area of Hong Kong, China.

(a) Identify **one** piece of equipment that could be used in this enquiry.

(1)

Mobile phone with camera for photographs

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Examiner Comments

One suitable piece of equipment. 1 mark. NB either mobile phone or camera would have scored here.

Question 6(b)

Many candidates wrongly interpreted this question to mean that they needed to identify one type of secondary data rather than list one of the secondary data sources collected by the students in the resource. If the question was interpreted correctly, most candidates could identify which of the stated data sources were secondary.

(b) Identify **one** type of secondary data used by the students.

(1)

Data on number of businesses that opened and closed in area.

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Examiner Comments

One correct method - 1 mark.

Question 6(c)

This question required candidates to explain why random sampling was chosen by students to collect questionnaire responses. Many candidates provided sound explanations, highlighting the ease of implementation and the reduction of bias. Several responses also included examples to illustrate how random sampling operates in practice, which helped to strengthen their answers.

(c) Explain why the students may have chosen random sampling for the questionnaire.

(3)

to reduce researcher bias by making sure they have a generalisable group of people to make the investigation reliable

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Examiner Comments

This response recognises that random sampling reduces bias and allows for more reliable results by capturing the views of a generalisable group of people. (3 marks)

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Examiner Tip

Learn the differences between systematic, random and stratified sampling.

(c) Explain why the students may have chosen random sampling for the questionnaire.

(3)

To make it fair: This will make a fair and reliable results. This will also get rid of any bias towards certain people in the Sample.

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Examiner Comments

Fairness is also a major issue when picking a representative sample as identified by this candidate – also 3 marks.

Question 6(d)i

In this question, candidates were required to use the data from Figure 6b to complete a bar chart. While many candidates completed the task successfully, some had difficulty accurately plotting the 95% segment, and others did not plot the correct data at all using a different site's data entirely. As long as the bars were in the correct order they did not need a label on this occasion to score both marks.

(d) (i) Plot the data for Site 1, Question 3, from Figure 6b in the Resource Booklet, to complete the bar chart in Figure 6c in the Question Paper.

(2)

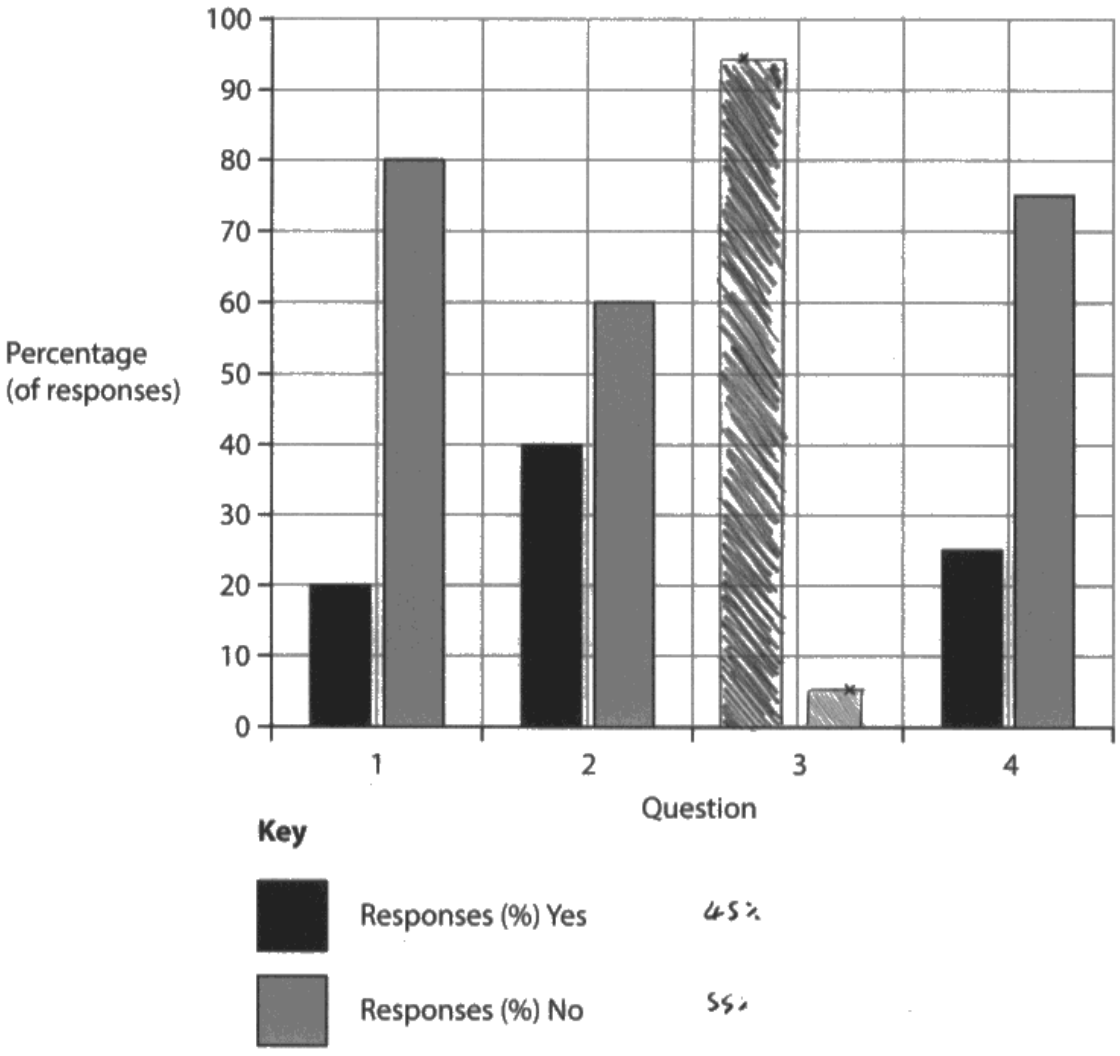


Figure 6c

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Examiner Comments

This response correctly plots the 95% 'Yes' bar and the 5% 'No' bar, achieving both marks - 2 marks.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Candidates should regularly practise constructing a variety of data presentation techniques, including bar charts. Attention should be paid to accurately selecting the correct data from a table or resource to ensure success every time.

Question 6(d)ii

This question required candidates to state one other method of data presentation method that could have been used for this data. The data was discrete and % data so should have been a pie chart or a compound bar chart. A minority suggested a bar chart again while others wrongly suggested a line or scatter graph.

(ii) State **one other** data presentation method that could have been used for the data shown in Figure 6c.

(1)

pie charts for each question



This response provides one valid method – 1 mark.



Candidates should be encouraged to consider what type of graph is most suitable for each type of data – especially knowing the difference between which graph type suits continuous and discrete data.

Question 6(d)iii

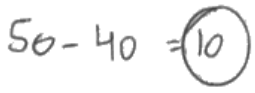
The majority scored two marks by putting the appropriate value in the answer space. A significant number of candidates struggled with this question but scored one mark for evidence of use of the correct approach to calculating a range but with incorrect data. A very common wrong answer was 80-60-20.

Candidates also frequently calculated the mean instead of the range.

(iii) Calculate the range in the number of responses for respondents that selected 'Yes' for Question 2 in Figure 6b in the Resource Booklet.

You **must** show all your workings.

(2)



10

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

Correct method for 1 mark, but wrong numbers/response, so no further credit.

(iii) Calculate the range in the number of responses for respondents that selected 'Yes' for Question 2 in Figure 6b in the Resource Booklet.

You **must** show all your workings.

(2)

50 - 20

30

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

Correct number (30) – 2 marks

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Practice statistical data manipulation such as mean, median, mode and range with data so this question does not catch you out in the exam room.

Question 6(e)

In this question, candidates were required to state one advantage and one disadvantage of the bar chart as a data presentation method, as shown in Figure 6c.

While many candidates did give good responses such as 'simple to draw' and 'difficult to read a scale when in 10% intervals' showing they had looked at the specific graph, others wrote very vague responses that did not suggest the graph had been looked at all.

(e) State **one** advantage and **one** disadvantage of the data presentation method used in Figure 6c.

(2)

advantage

The data is accurate

disadvantage

Could be confusing for someone to read / understand

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This sample shows two very vague statements that do not relate to the bar chart at all. The first part relates to the data, and the disadvantage suggests it may be confusing but this is not related to the graph in any way. 0 marks.

Question 6(f)

This question assessed both AO3 and AO4, focusing on a familiar fieldwork context. Candidates were asked to evaluate the importance of qualitative data in reaching their own conclusions. Some demonstrated a secure understanding of what qualitative data are and how it can positively influence the reliability and clarity of a conclusion. The strongest responses provided a balanced and well-supported evaluation, with clear and explicit references to the candidate's own fieldwork investigations. Few related these to their conclusions in any meaningful way.

(f) You have studied urban environments as part of your own geographical enquiry.

Evaluate the importance of qualitative data in helping you reach your conclusions.

(8)

State the title of your geographical enquiry.

To investigate the impacts of West Quay Regeneration Scheme on Southampton.

In our investigation we firstly used qualitative data in our Questionnaires. These helped us to gain the public opinion on what people thought of the Area of Southampton and the effects that the West Quay regeneration ~~Scheme~~ scheme has brought socially. We used open ended questions to gain more ~~opinion~~ detail in peoples opinions and ~~closed~~ close ended questions to anylise opinions. The qualitative data of our questionnaires was very important as it gave us a direct insight into what people thought the social impacts of Southampton were, however it was hard to anylise as the qualitative data was subject to the opinion of the person we interviewed and many didn't know the area very well.

Another method of qualitative data we used was we took photographs along the 1km transect of Above bar street and the High Street and then we annotated them. These photos, with the help of historic photos helped us understand the change in scenery of Southampton before and after the

construction of West Quay Regeneration Scheme therefore were very important in gaining an understanding of its impact to the area. However this qualitative data of annotated photographs was just a snapshot in time and many of them missed things out.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response achieves level 2, 6 marks. There is clear reference and description of two types of qualitative data used in the candidate's investigation. The response includes explicit reference to their own fieldwork in Southampton but the candidate attempts to evaluate their method looking only at the data collected and not the method, stating it was 'hard to analyse', but not why it was hard to analyse. Weak data does not mean analysis is difficult. There is also no mention of their conclusion and so it is very difficult to move this to a higher mark as part of the question has not been addressed.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Candidates should be encouraged to critically assess all aspects of their enquiry by explicitly linking their methods to the original aims and final conclusions. They should also ensure that evidence from their own data collection is used to support and justify their conclusions.

Question 7(a)iii

This question required candidates to state two impacts of deforestation.

The majority of responses referred to climate change, habitat loss, release of stored carbon/global warming, soil erosion, flash flooding or desertification.

(iii) State **two** impacts of deforestation.

(2)

1 loss of biodiversity

2 increase in CO2 in atmosphere.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

1 mark for loss of biodiversity. 1 mark for increase of Carbon Dioxide in the atmosphere. 2 marks total.

Question 7(b)i

This question required candidates to identify one labelled country with the highest number of people at risk of sea level rise, using Figure 7a.

While the majority of candidates correctly identified India, a small number selected other countries from the figure that were not labelled, resulting in no credit.

(b) (i) Study Figure 7a in the Resource Booklet.

Identify **one** labelled country with the most people at risk from sea level rise.

(1)

~~Japan~~ inaxa Japan

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

Incorrect country identified - 0 marks.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Candidates should be encouraged to read questions carefully and pay close attention to the wording and visual detail in figures, ensuring their responses accurately meet the question's requirements.

Question 7(b)ii

This question required candidates to describe the pattern of people at risk of sea level rise in South America, using Figure 7a—a world map showing the number of people per country at risk from predicted sea level rise by 2100. When a question refers to a 'pattern', it is essential that candidates identify and describe a clear spatial trend. This can be achieved by referring to specific regions, clusters, or groups of at least two countries. Doing so demonstrates effective use of the resource, which is necessary to access AO3 marks. Some candidates' responses were not creditworthy as they failed to identify a viable pattern, instead offering isolated or vague observations.

(ii) Describe the pattern of risk in South America.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Figure 7a shows a variation in risk in South America as Chile has below 0.1 million in population and therefore has less risk whilst Brazil has 1 to 9.9 million in population and therefore has a higher risk.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

The first mark is given for the identification of the pattern: “there is a variation of risk in South America”. The second mark is given for the use of the data from Figure 7a: Brazil has a higher risk/Chile has less risk (with data to prove the point). 2 marks.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

World maps are frequently used in examinations so it’s a good idea for candidates to be able to recognise how to interpret patterns, trends, differences and similarities in such resources.

Question 7(b)iii

This question required candidates to suggest one reason for the pattern shown in Figure 7a. As with all 'suggest' questions based on a resource, candidates needed to both identify a pattern and provide a reason for that pattern. Some responses achieved one mark by identifying either the pattern or a plausible reason, but not both.

Stronger responses explained the pattern by linking high-risk areas to population density, noting that countries with large populations and/or many coastal cities are more vulnerable to sea level rise. Altitude was another favourite correct reason. Many candidates were unclear abour the location of the equator. A similarly large number did not understand the implications of the equator, suggesting that deserts are found on the equator.

(iii) Suggest **one** reason for the pattern shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Becase Brazil is higher in population than Chile and Argentina, meaning more peoplee ~~are~~ are at risk.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

The first mark is given for the identification of the pattern; more people at risk in Brazil than Argentina or Chile. The second mark is given for the reason: because Brazil has a higher population. 2 marks.

(iii) Suggest **one** reason for the pattern shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

~~Chi~~ Chille is a mountainous country with high altitudes where are Brazil is more low lying, therefore sea levels rising will affect ~~Brazil a lot more~~. Brazilian cits like Sao Pablo more.



1 mark for reason; Brazil is low lying/Chile is mountainous. Second mark for sea levels will affect Brazilian cities like Sao Paulo more. 2 marks.



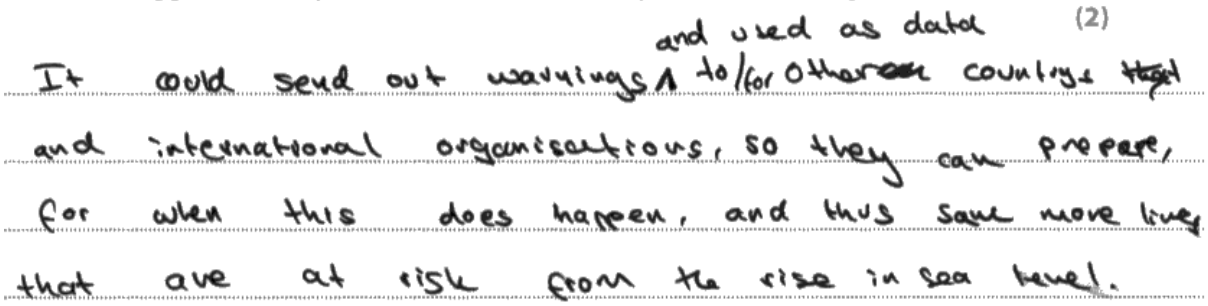
A pattern needs to relate to 2 or more countries or a region of a country (northern versus southern, for instance)

Question 7(b)iv

This question required candidates to suggest one way this data could be used by international organisations to guide where adaptation strategies are most needed. Stronger responses developed this by explaining how it could help allocate funding or resources to high-risk areas. Others recognised the potential for the data to support international agreements on climate change, using it as evidence to highlight the urgency of global action.

Less developed responses tended to make vague statements about helping people without explaining how data would inform decisions or be used by international organisations, which limited the depth of their response.

(iv) Suggest **one** way this data could be used by international organisations. (2)





This response gives a developed example of a how an organisation can prepare countries by warning them and thereby saving lives from this risk, for 2 marks.

Question 7(c)

This question required candidates to state two impacts of climate change. Many candidates wrote responses such as increased temperatures, extreme weather events, and melting ice caps.

Some stronger answers also mentioned more complex ideas such as disrupted ecosystems, shifting weather patterns or climate-induced displacement.

A minority of candidates misinterpreted the question to be about causes of climate change, incorrectly suggesting sunspots or volcanic activity.

(c) Sea level rise is one impact of climate change.

State **two other** impacts of climate change.

(2)

1 Extreme weather events like heat waves ocean

2 Loss of ^biodiversity due to ocean warming and death of coral reefs and marine life.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This gives two clear and detailed impacts of climate change -2 marks

(c) Sea level rise is one impact of climate change.

State **two other** impacts of climate change.

(2)

1 Health

2 Employment

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This is an example of a weaker response for no credit.

Question 7(d)

This question required candidates to explain how solar variations and farming contribute to climate change. Many candidates produced well-developed responses, particularly to the farming segment including cows and paddy fields creating methane which is a greenhouse gas. The solar variations part was less well understood. Stronger responses referred to increased sunspot activity or Milankovitch cycles and how these alter the amount of solar radiation received by earth. Weaker answers confused solar variation with man-made causes or gave vague statements about "sunlight" without further explanation. To score well, both causes needed to be addressed with clear development.

(d) Explain how solar variations and farming contribute to climate change.

(4)

solar variations

~~When~~ The earth rotate around the Sun and the rotation is eliptical. This means that ~~most of the~~ some times ~~we~~ the Sun is closer and sometimes it is far away. This ~~is caused~~ causes more heat which lead to climate change.

farming

farming involves growing cows to extract milk. This means that cows release methane which is a green house gas. This traps heat which contributes to climate change.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response includes two relevant contributions. The solar variation part was just enough for both marks - 4 marks.

Question 7(e)

The command word in this question is 'assess', which requires candidates to make a judgement—in this case, about the importance of biodiversity loss as a cause of desertification. While candidates are not expected to address every aspect of the resource, they are required to use it effectively to support their argument.

Lower-level responses tended to offer brief comments on each part of the resource without developing a clear line of reasoning. In contrast, higher-level responses demonstrated a well-supported judgement, evaluating the extent to which biodiversity loss and climate change contribute to desertification and often comparing it to other contributing factors.

Stronger responses recognised that biodiversity loss is both a cause and consequence of desertification. These candidates explained that the loss of vegetation and habitats leads to reduced ground cover, which increases the risk of soil erosion and land degradation. Many also referenced Figure 7b effectively, noting how desertification operates as a feedback loop, worsening over time through impacts such as the loss of soil nutrients, moisture, and increased CO_2 emissions.

Weaker responses often lacked evaluation and focused too narrowly on biodiversity without comparing it to other causes like overgrazing, population pressure, or drought. A common limitation was that candidates lifted phrases or labels from the resource without interpreting or analysing them. These responses tended to describe the diagram rather than assess the importance of biodiversity loss in relation to other contributing factors.

Some excellent answers explained how biodiversity loss could be mitigated (eg Great Green Wall) and therefore was less important than climate change.

(e) Study Figure 7b in the Resource Booklet.

Assess the importance of biodiversity loss as a cause of desertification.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(6)

Biodiversity loss is an important cause of desertification, arguably more important than climate change. Figure 7b, shows that ~~decreased diversity~~ biodiversity loss leads to decreased diversity of plants and soil organisms, which then leads to desertification. This is because biodiversity means the number of different organisms in an ecosystem. If this ~~decreased~~ decreases then the number of different plants and soil organisms decrease too. This means that the soil won't have as many nutrients, making it more infertile. This can cause it to dry out, leading to desertification. This shows how biodiversity loss is actually a significant cause of desertification. However, climate change is also a key cause of desertification too. Figure 7b shows how an increase in ~~climate~~ extreme weather events leads to desertification. This is because ~~events such as~~ climate change can lead to an increase in global temperature, meaning that the land is even more dry and arid, meaning that the soil dries out further. However, this is not as important as biodiversity loss, as ~~this~~ the loss of diversity of soil nutrients and moisture directly leads to desertification.



This response explores the role of biodiversity loss in causing desertification and effectively contrasts it with the role of climate change. The candidate starts and concludes each paragraph with a clear assessment, making a reasoned judgement about which factor has the most direct impact on desertification. 6 marks.



Greater familiarity with the 'assess' command word is strongly recommended for future examinations. Candidates may find it helpful to begin their answers with a clear judgement or assessment, followed by supporting evidence drawn from the resource and their own knowledge. This approach can help ensure responses are focused and well-structured.

Question 7(f)

This question features the command word 'discuss' and assesses AO2, AO3, and AO4. Candidates are required to assimilate the specific resources referenced in the question and explore the issue by weighing arguments for and against the statement (agree vs. disagree). The question clearly specifies which resources must be used. To achieve the highest marks, candidates need to integrate evidence from both resources effectively. Additionally, it is crucial that candidates supplement the resources with their own knowledge and understanding to develop a well-supported and balanced response.

Candidates are required to use Figures 7a and 7b to discuss the view: *The greatest impacts of climate change will be linked to sea level rise.*

This extended response encouraged candidates to engage in a balanced discussion about whether sea level rise represents the greatest impact of climate change.

Stronger answers used Figures 7a and 7b effectively, noting that sea level rise places tens of millions at risk—particularly in Southeast Asia—and presents serious threats to low-lying coastal regions. These responses also acknowledged other major impacts, such as drought, extreme weather, biodiversity loss, and food shortages. High-level answers examined the uneven distribution of impacts and the uncertainty surrounding their severity and future outcomes. Figure 7b was used to highlight how desertification can lead to increased CO□ emissions, further intensifying climate change.

Some excellent answers suggested that desertification could be resolved while sea level rise could not.

The best responses offered a well-structured argument supported by evidence and evaluation.

Weaker answers often listed impacts without analysis or failed to engage with the viewpoint critically. There were a lot of strong responses to the question which demonstrated good AO3 and AO4, but sometimes lacked AO2.

(f) Discuss the view:

"The greatest impacts of climate change will be linked to sea level rise."

Use Figures 7a and 7b from the Resource Booklet, and your own knowledge and understanding to support your answer.

You **must** refer to the resources in your answer.

(12)

Sea level rise will have a significant impact mostly damaging. If you look at coral reefs for example sea level rise will completly wipe them out. It will also get rid of the habitats living there. This can reduce tourists having negative effects on the countries economy. ~~A~~ According to 7a most of the world is at risk for sea level rise this have major impacts on poorer countries who can't afford to raise buildings or people who can't afford to move. Enviornments and habitats will completely change. In some serious cases sea level rise can result in death particularly of habitats. Homes and businesses may need to move in serious cases ~~some~~ towns can be wiped out. This can have a serious effect on peoples mental health especially children. Although this seems all bad some places may benefit from this. for example deserfified places near water. As we can see a rise in water levels may help places like 7b. ~~Near~~ Any

nearby dryland or desertified land can benefit. More plants can begin to grow which can attract new ecosystems and habitats to stay. The unusable land which ~~was~~ used to be homes and businesses is forever destroyed wiping out populations as we ~~know~~ know it. Instead of having a bit of a temperature rise the ground we ~~step~~ on being replaced with water will have an immense and scary impact. An impact that may not fluctuate.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response meets the criteria for Level 2 and is awarded 7 marks. The candidate gives a good range of AO2 points to start with, discussing coral reef damage and the negative impacts this will have on tourism and the subsequent impact on the economy of the countries, but doesn't tell us where this will be. It then goes on to look at 7a identifying poorer nations being at greater risk but does not name them. Also, it looks at other effects such as mental health issues and different groups being affected. It goes on to mention 7b but misidentifies that saltwater inundation could be helpful to put water back in places that have lost it – but does identify the irreversible nature of the issues and the costs of it both spatially and temporally to a very limited degree. This response is not especially coherent but its ideas relate to the question and it has gone beyond the sources it has been given, although the candidate has only used both sources in a very limited way. These are all traits of an upper level 2 response.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

It is important that a clear judgement is made. This is usually provided with a summary at the end of the response.

(f) Discuss the view:

"The greatest impacts of climate change will be linked to sea level rise."

Use Figures 7a and 7b from the Resource Booklet, and your own knowledge and understanding to support your answer.

You **must** refer to the resources in your answer.

(12)

Climate change refers to increase in global atmospheric temperatures over a long period of time. Sea level rise, loss of biodiversity, food scarcity etc. are just a few examples of impacts due to climate change. Moreover, sea level rise refers to the rise in water due to increased temperatures.

Firstly, I partially agree with the statement that the greatest impacts of climate change will be linked to sea level rise as Figure 7a, shows evidence that the number of people per country at risk from predicted sea level rise is 10 - 50 million in a country such as India. This is because due to urbanisation and industrialisation in India, green house gas emissions will increase in the atmosphere causing global temperatures to increase and therefore contribute to climate change. This will cause people living in low-lying coastal areas to migrate due to high risk of flooding. Therefore it can be said that developing countries as well as developed countries ~~are~~ surrounded by the ocean are at higher risk. Moreover, due to seat level rise, farming activities closer to the ocean are at risk. This will cause food scarcity due to decreased plants as shown in Figure 7b.

~~Second~~ However, I partially disagree with the statement that the greatest impacts of climate change will be linked to

Sea level rise as it is a more regional impact, meaning land locked countries such as Russia ~~are~~ have only 0.1 - 0.4a million people at risk due to sea level rise, compared to China and India. Moreover, as shown in Figure 7b, desertification is also another major impact due to climate change. For example the Sahel region in Africa is currently undergoing high rates of desertification. This is because when trees are cut down for non-forestry purposes, contribution to climate change is more due to increased green house gases such as carbon dioxide in the atmosphere.

In conclusion, even though both desertification and sea level rise ~~has~~ have major impacts on countries in the world. I believe sea level rise is the most significant impact of climate change.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This reponse achieves Level 3 – 9 marks. The candidate makes multiple decisions throughout their discussion. Their answer has a much clearer structure and it is more cogent than the one before. It has spatial awareness and economic awareness relating to sea level rise, and while it is not always factually correct in all its examples, they have used a range of case study material from the sources and their own knowledge (Sahel) and most of the concepts are correct. For these reasons it has been awarded a low level 3 score.

Question 8(a)iii

Most candidates could identify two impacts of rural-urban migration with most impacts being identified as linked to overcrowding in urban destinations rather than labour shortages in rural origins. This likely reflects the numbers of candidates who study Urban Environments rather than Rural Environments.

Question 8(b)i

This question required candidates to identify one labelled country with the highest level of positive net migration, using Figure 8a. While the majority of candidates correctly identified Australia, a small number selected other countries from the figure that were not labelled, resulting in no credit. Canada was a particularly popular wrong choice.

Most candidates correctly identified Australia.

Question 8(b)ii

This question required candidates to describe the pattern of net migration for Europe, using Figure 8a—a world map showing the net annual migration per 1000 population in 2020. When a question refers to a 'pattern', it is essential that candidates identify and describe a clear spatial trend. This can be achieved by referring to specific regions, clusters, or groups of at least two countries. Doing so demonstrates effective use of the resource, which is necessary to access AO3 marks.

Some candidates' responses were not creditworthy as they failed to identify a viable pattern, instead offering isolated or vague observations or reasons that would have scored in subsequent questions but did not satisfy the command term here.

(ii) Describe the pattern of net migration for Europe.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

People Migrate tends of war in the country. the patterns show the negative Migration e.g Pakistan and Positive net Migration e.g Japan.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response scores 0 because it does not attempt to identify a pattern for Europe as required by the question stem.

(ii) Describe the pattern of net migration for Europe.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Most countries in europe have a positive net migration which could be due to higher levels of HICs.

ResultsPlus Examiner Comments

This response scores 1 mark for identifying a relevant pattern but then gives a reason which is not what the question asks for. 1 mark total.

(ii) Describe the pattern of net migration for Europe.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

Figure 8a shows that northern, central, and Western Europe have between 0 to 100 + net annual population. However a few countries in eastern ~~europe~~ Europe have between -0.1 to -100 ormore net migration (2)



This response scores 2 marks. It uses compass directions to identify a valid pattern across the continent of Europe and then quotes data to back up its point. The progression shown in this sequence of responses can be used to support learning how to achieve both marks on this style of question.



Candidates should be given regular opportunities to practise identifying trends and patterns from a variety of stimulus materials, including maps and graphs. They should be encouraged to support their observations with specific data from the resource to strengthen their responses and access higher-level marks.

Question 8(b)iii

This question required candidates to suggest one impact for the pattern shown in Figure 8a for host countries. As with all 'suggest' questions based on a resource, candidates are expected to both identify a clear pattern and provide a reason for that pattern. Some responses achieved one mark by addressing only one element—either the pattern or a plausible reason. Stronger responses demonstrated a more complete understanding by linking migration patterns to issues such as skills being accrued and brain gain in the donor countries.

Others offered a more negative interpretation, referencing the role of overpopulation causing services such as schools and hospitals to be overstretched.

(iii) Suggest **one** possible impact of the pattern shown for host (destination) countries.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Migration to a country can cause to house price increase because when population increases Value of houses increases because available houses & numbers will decrease

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response is awarded 1 mark for identifying the impact of house prices increasing owing to increased demand. To achieve full marks, the candidate would have needed to identify a pattern from the resource.

Question 8(b)iv

This question required candidates to suggest one reason why the migration pattern shown is useful in understanding the global economy. Many candidates were able to identify a valid point, such as the filling of skills gaps in host countries, which was typically awarded one mark. However, few candidates developed their ideas fully to explain how this contributes to the growth of the global economy, which was necessary to access the second mark. This highlights the need for greater focus on linking individual impacts to wider global processes in extended reasoning.

(iv) Suggest **one** reason Figure 8a may be useful for understanding the global economy.

(2)

It shows how stronger economies attract more migrants.



This response gives a basic example of a reason for the growth of the global economy. 1 mark.

Question 8(c)

This question required candidates to state two reasons for the growth of mass tourism. The majority of candidates were able to correctly identify two valid factors and achieved full marks.

The most frequently cited responses included disposable income, package holidays and cheaper air travel as causes.

Question 8(d)

This question required candidates to explain two economic impacts of mass tourism. Many responses were well developed, with particular focus on job opportunities creating tax revenue for developing the region and economic leakage from importing tourism food and beverage to suit the tourist's palate. However, some candidates found it more challenging to fully develop their points. As with other 4-mark 'explain' questions, it is essential that candidates extend their answers beyond basic statements by clearly explaining the reasoning or consequences in order to access full marks. There were some outstanding references to economic leakage through TNCs, mentioning relevant company examples.

A significant minority referred to environmental or social impacts for no credit.

(d) Explain **two** economic impacts of mass tourism.

(4)

1 More job opportunities, decreases poverty rate and while tax also increasing ~~th~~ affordability of the country.

2 ~~Also~~ more, higher taxes are being paid to the governmet. Because in countries like Cyprus more hotels are being build ~~and~~ that increases number of people working there. This also increases the tax paymat to governmet increasing GDP per capita and promoting economy.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response provides two developed economic impacts for 4 marks.

(d) Explain **two** economic impacts of mass tourism.

(4)

1 High amounts of pollution due to tourists leaving trash ~~in~~ on the floor, beach or water which causes lower quality water ~~to~~ and less visually pleasing.

2 Conflicts can occur ~~between~~ with tourism as some tourists do not follow certain rules of the country through, possibly, religious beliefs.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response failed to answer the question posed looking at social/cultural and environmental issues. The question was on economic benefits only.

Question 8(e)

As in the previous 6 marks in section C, the command word 'assess' is one that a very large number of candidates have difficulty with.In the specification this is defined as: *Use evidence to determine the relative significance of something. Give consideration to all factors and identify which are the most important.* In other words, candidates are required to rank and/or make a judgement.

This question focused on the impacts of transnational corporations (TNCs).

Lower-level responses often took the form of a list, with brief, undeveloped comments on the functions of these organisations. While such responses could gain some credit, they lacked the depth and assessment required for higher-level marks. In contrast, the most effective responses began with a clear judgement, selected a limited number of TNC impacts to explore in detail, and provided justification as to which TNC impacts are most significant. Well-structured responses that maintained a clear line of reasoning throughout were more likely to achieve the highest level marks.

(e) Study Figure 8b in the Resource Booklet.

Assess the impacts of transnational corporations (TNCs).

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(6)

TNCs As shown in the Figure 8b, TNCs increase investment in areas and can lead to ~~the~~ increased investment into economies from other regions. These TNCs can provide jobs to people – increasing their disposable income and creating a multiplier effect in the economy, from higher purchasing power. As seen in Figure 8b, TNCs can also improve infrastructure like roads and transport — once again providing jobs — but crucially improving transport links and the Quality of Life of people.

However, as seen in the Figure 8b, TNCs often pay low wages and have a global shift to ~~countries with lower cheaper~~ LICs or MICs with cheap(er) labour to maximise their own profits, this can lead to the exploitation of workers and poor unfair working conditions too. Furthermore, the Figure 8c shows that ~~there~~ there is environmental damage too, this is due to TNCs locating in countries with laxed environmental policies to once again maximise profits. TNCs often withdraw up to 95% of profits ~~of~~ from host country too, leading to economic leakage



This candidate has written a range of developed and pertinent points but has included no assessment or judgement as to which impact is more or less important, limiting the mark to Level 2, 5 marks.

(e) Study Figure 8b in the Resource Booklet.

Assess the impacts of transnational corporations (TNCs).

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(6)

Impacts of TNCs

Positive

Increased Investments

These ~~with~~ Investment will bring in more money that the goverment will be able to use to develop the City / country even further

Improved Infrastructures

This is help with the ~~city~~ cities Image bringing in ~~more~~ tourists that help tax and make the ecomony better and more diversified

Environmental damage

TNCS like coca cola use bottles to put the soft drinks in. Bottles are made of Plastic making them non- biodegradable making it bad for the environment

Low wages for workers

since TNCs are everywhere they overworks worker and give them low wages to compansat for their hard labour



This candidate has written briefly about several impacts of TNCs from the resource in a list-like fashion but has no clear development or assessment. It does use a relevant example related to one of the aspects of the source to move it up to Level 2, 4 marks.

Question 8(f)

This question features the command word 'discuss' and assesses AO2, AO3, and AO4. Candidates are required to assimilate the specific resources referenced in the question and explore the issue by weighing arguments for and against the statement (agree vs. disagree). The question clearly specifies which resources must be used. To achieve the highest marks, candidates need to integrate evidence from both resources effectively. Additionally, it is crucial that candidates supplement the resources with their own knowledge and understanding to develop a well-supported and balanced response.

In this question, candidates were required to use Figures 8a and 8b to discuss the view: *"Transnational corporations (TNCs) are one of the most important factors for the growth of the global economy."* Most candidates supported the view, drawing on ideas related to the positives and negatives of transnational corporations and migration, as these themes were reflected in the stimulus material. Stronger responses demonstrated the ability to integrate evidence from both figures with their own knowledge, while also considering alternative perspectives or the relative importance of other drivers in the global economy such as trade, communications and transport.

There were a lot of strong responses to the question which demonstrated good AO3 and AO4, but sometimes lacked AO2.

(f) Discuss the view:

> "Transnational corporations (TNCs) are one of the most important factors for the growth of the global economy."

Use Figures 8a and 8b from the Resource Booklet, and your own knowledge and understanding to support your answer.

You **must** refer to the resources in your answer.

(12)

Transnational corperations are large companies, whose country of origin is often in HICs, which often operate in LICs and globally. There are also many factors that help globalisation and the growth of a global economy, like IT, transport and communication, eased trading laws and migration.

~~Figure~~ I agree with this statement as TNCs play a huge part in creating a global economy by operating in many different countries, employing many people and generating lots of wealth. Firstly figure 8a shows lots of LICs having lots of negative net migration. These immigrants may have earned enough money to migrate by working for a TNC. This immigration by the wealth generated by TNCs helps grow a global economy by cultural diversity being created. figure 8b also shows that TNCs lead to increased investment and improved infrastructure

for the LIC they operate in. This helps the growth of the global economy by allowing LICs to gain income, allowing for better trading with HICs, this could lead to good geopolitical relationships which can help countries form trading blocs to help them in the future. Finally TNCs are able to also produce certain products which can be shipped around the world, spreading cultural awareness globally.

I however disagree with this paragraph as there are many very important factors for the growth of the global economy. For example transport ~~and communications are~~ is vital for the growth of the global economy as it helps the 'shrinking world' so transport of goods and people have become much faster, allowing for more economic growth. Technology and communications are also vital for the spread of ideas across the world, this has allowed for lots of innovation. Figure 8a also shows high levels of general migration which is also important in the growth of a global economy, as cultures, languages and ways of life can be exchanged as well as money in the form of remittances. Figure 8b also shows negative impacts of TNCs such as worker exploitation and environmental damage. These might therefore take away from their amazing benefits to global economies.

In conclusion I agree with this statement to a moderate extent as I believe TNCs are vital to the growth of a global economy, yet they do have their drawbacks both ethically and environmentally, and other factors are also necessary for the growth of a global economy

(Total for Question 8 = 35 marks)



This is a strong Level 3 response that shows good understanding of concepts and interrelationships in the geography. They deconstruct ideas across resources with explicit use of data and evidence. There is also a clear conclusion. There is some AO2 present in terms of an array of ideas and concepts, and excellent terminology but this could have been stronger if more specific named case studies had been used which prevents it from reaching full marks.



Candidates should practise producing balanced responses to extended questions, ensuring they consider multiple viewpoints and provide material for effective discussion. To strengthen their answers, candidates should be encouraged to read more widely around the specification content, using sources such as newspapers, magazines, and reputable online articles to deepen their contextual understanding. In addition, candidates should focus on developing their ability to demonstrate their own knowledge and understanding (AO2) alongside their use of source material. This is particularly important in longer extended response questions where synthesis of ideas and reasoned judgement are required to access the higher mark levels.

Question 9(a)ii

Although a majority of candidates were able to identify age and gender as the two features of interest relating to population structure shown on a population pyramid, many others offered responses that linked more to inferences that could be made from the age and gender make up of population pyramids, such as dependency ratio or working age population.

Common incorrect answers were where candidates were trying to describe population pyramids for different types of country, eg small base/large base and what this symbolised.

Question 9(b)i

This question required candidates to identify one labelled country with the highest level of water insecurity, using Figure 9a. While the majority of candidates correctly identified Saudi Arabia, a small number selected other 'burgundy' countries from the figure that were not labelled, resulting in no credit.

Question 9(b)ii

This question required candidates to describe the pattern of water security in Africa using Figure 9a—a world map showing global water stress (insecurity) by 2040. When a question refers to a 'pattern', it is essential that candidates identify and describe a clear spatial trend. This can be achieved by referring to specific regions, clusters, or groups of at least two countries. Doing so demonstrates effective use of the resource, which is necessary to access AO3 marks. Some candidates' responses were not creditworthy as they failed to identify a viable pattern, instead offering isolated or vague observations.

(ii) Describe the pattern of water security in Africa.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Central Africa has mostly a low to a low to medium water stress level, in the ~~else~~ north and south water stress levels became high and extremely high.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response is awarded 2 marks. One mark for identifying the pattern of Central Africa being at low risk in contrast to the north and south where water stress in extremely low/high. Pattern plus risk types is enough for 2 marks here as the data on the map is given in words not numbers.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Tip

Reasons are not needed for a describe command word.

Question 9(b)iii

This question required candidates to suggest one reason for the pattern shown in Figure 9a. As with all 'suggest' questions based on a resource, candidates were expected to identify a clear pattern and provide a justified reason for it. Some responses gained one mark by addressing only one aspect—either the pattern or a plausible reason. Stronger responses showed a more complete understanding by linking the level of water security in a country to rainfall and desert conditions to explain the observed pattern.

(iii) Suggest **one** reason for the pattern shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

Figure 9a shows Central African Countries the tend to have low water insecurity. This may be because they're on the equator so have more heavy / frequent rainfall

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response is awarded 2 marks for identifying the pattern and giving a reason for this pattern.

(iii) Suggest **one** reason for the pattern shown.

You **must** refer to the resource in your answer.

(2)

because North affica is close to the equator so it's hotter and has more droughts than centeral africa.

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response is a classic example of a candidate being uncertain where the equator is – had they named the correct location they would have been correct but with the map projection missing out Antarctica this may have meant the equator was in a different place than the candidate thought.

Question 9(b)iv

This question required candidates to suggest one way in which the pattern of water security could affect human welfare. The majority of candidates were able to provide developed responses, most commonly focusing on the impacts of dehydration and water source contamination. These responses often made effective links between limited water access and consequences such as poor health, reduced life expectancy owing to illness, and decreased productivity.

(iv) Suggest **one** way the pattern shown could affect human welfare.

(2)

Areas with higher water insecurity will have lower human welfare as ~~[illegible]~~ dehydration can lead to health issues or drinking unsafe water which can lead to typhoid or diptheria

ResultsPlus
Examiner Comments

This response scores both marks - it identifies one way human welfare could be affected with full exemplification of it. 2 marks.

Question 9(c)

Most candidates were able to identify types of trade or aid that could reduce uneven development. Some students were not clear on whether this question related to development within or between countries, suggesting the building of a high-speed railway as a way to (eventually) reduce uneven development. More common responses were fairtrade, bilateral aid, Foreign Direct Investment (FDI), tax breaks and government incentives.

Question 9(d)

This question required candidates to explain reasons why the Human Development Index (HDI) and measures of inequality are useful for understanding differences in development. The majority of candidates answered the HDI section better than the inequality section. The Gini coefficient was commonly mentioned, as were corrupt governments and gender inequality to a lesser extent.

Question 9(e)

As in the previous 6 marks in section C, the command word 'assess' is one that a very large number of candidates have difficulty in understanding what exactly it is they are meant to do. In the specification this is defined as: *Use evidence to determine the relative significance of something. Give consideration to all factors and identify which are the most important.* In other words, candidates are required to rank and/or make a judgement.

This question focused on how factors have led to uneven development between countries shown in Figure 9b and how these have contributed to uneven development. Many candidates demonstrated a good understanding of the different factors involved. The most effective responses began with a clear, well-reasoned judgement and revisited this in the conclusion, resulting in a well-structured and cohesive answer. Some candidates also approached the question by dividing their paragraphs into human and physical causes of uneven development—an approach that proved effective when accompanied by clear explanation and evaluation.

As with 7e and 8e there was very little assessment at the lower end with most candidates just writing a virtual bullet point list of the impact of each issue without reference to their relative merits.

Some excellent answers joined the issues together well (eg natural resources taken by other nations as part payment for infrastructure projects). Very few pointed out that some wealthy countries have developed *despite* the issues in the figure.

Question 9(f)

This question features the command word 'discuss' and assesses AO2, AO3, and AO4. Candidates are required to assimilate the specific resources referenced in the question and explore the issue by weighing arguments for and against the statement (agree vs. disagree). The question clearly specifies which resources must be used. To achieve the highest marks, candidates need to integrate evidence from both resources effectively. Additionally, it is crucial that candidates supplement the resources with their own knowledge and understanding to develop a well-supported and balanced response.

In this question, candidates were required to use Figures 9a and 9b to discuss the view: *"Efforts to reduce the development gap should always focus on economic improvements."* Most candidates did not support the statement, drawing on themes from the stimulus material such as water security or insecurity, and the physical and human factors contributing to uneven development. Stronger responses successfully integrated evidence from both Figures alongside their own knowledge, demonstrating thoughtful evaluation. While many responses showed strong AO3 (interpretation and analysis) and AO4 (application of skills), some lacked sufficient AO2 (knowledge and understanding) which limited access to the highest levels. The use of the word 'always' in the question created debate.

Most candidates wrote more in line with 'what is the best way to develop a country'. Some candidates gave a rundown of bottom-up versus top-down aid without a focus on economic (or other) improvements. Several excellent answers explained that economic improvement could be used to achieve social improvements but there was very limited reference to places they might have studied.

Candidates should practise blending their own knowledge with unfamiliar resources provided in the examination. In longer extended responses, the ability to engage in analytical discussion is crucial for accessing higher levels. Although this is typically the final question on the paper, it carries a high tariff, so candidates should be encouraged to plan and attempt it thoroughly, rather than overlooking it owing to time pressure.

Paper Summary

Based on their performance on this paper, candidates are offered the following advice:

- When answering the extended response questions, ensure you are clear about the requirements for different commands words such as 'analyse', 'evaluate', 'assess' or 'discuss'
  - 'analyse' - investigate an issue by breaking it down into different components and making logical, evidence-based connections between these components.
  - 'evaluate' - measure the value or success of something, and ultimately, provide a substantiated judgement or conclusion.
  - 'assess' - provide evidence to determine the relative significance of something, considering all factors and identifying which are the most important
  - 'discuss' - explore the strengths and weaknesses of different sides of an issue/statement or question through reasoning and argument.
- Appreciate that the extended writing questions 8 marks are dominated by AO3 and AO4. Poorly balanced responses that concentrate on one of the AOs, or on AO1, in general will be confined to Level 1 or low-Level 2. Candidates benefit from practising this type of question from the beginning of the course.
- In the 12-mark extended response question in section C it is important to remember there are AO2 marks, which require your own knowledge and understanding to be demonstrated, as well as clear interpretation of the resources.
- Remember that while the extended response questions do not require a concluding paragraph, this is often the most effective way for you to demonstrate that you have met the command word, particularly where a judgement is required.
- Make good use of the resources, particularly in the extended response questions. It is important in the lower tariff questions where there is a resource related to the question that it is referred to, in some form, where required. It is important that evidence from the resource is used to answer the question as these are targeting AO3 (application of knowledge and understanding).
- Consider the number of marks awarded for each question to determine how much you need to develop your ideas. A 2- mark 'describe' question requires only some development to reach the second mark while a 3-mark 'explain' question requires further development.
- Where there is a question that asks to explain two ideas then you only need to provide some development for each rather than providing almost an extended response answer for one of these ideas. If a question is only worth 2-marks, you are not using your time effectively by writing a long answer.
- Where questions require you to describe data it is important you focus on description rather than trying to explain particular features of the data. Description can be identification of a trend or pattern (increase, decrease, fluctuation), which can be developed with further description (eg particular years where the pattern/trend changed), or through use of data to support the initial point. If looking at a graph use information from both axes in your response.

- For Section B, spend some time reviewing the different stages of geographical enquiry to ensure you are aware of what takes place at the different stages. This will help you to prepare for extended response questions on fieldwork which target different stages in the enquiry. Pay attention to the stage of the enquiry being assessed to ensure you are providing the right response, eg recognising the difference between data collection methods and data presentation techniques.
- Be really clear which type of geographical fieldwork you have completed and which question in the examination paper this will align with: Energy and Economic Activity (Q4), Rural Environments (Q5) or Urban Environments (Q6).
- You are encouraged to use the Sample Assessment Materials (SAMs), specimen papers and past papers to familiarise yourself with the structure of the paper and the style of questions; this will hopefully avoid situations where the rubric has not been followed.
- Review support material to become more familiar with the range of command words and how they are attached to different Assessment Objectives.
- Only write within the answer space provided, and not underneath or to the side of the answer space. Do not write in the margins of the page, or on blank parts of pages in the exam script. Use additional pages if you need more answer space and make sure these are clearly labelled with the question number.

Grade boundaries

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